



Chapter 6: The "Clothes" (Intro to CSS)

I. Introduction & The Cascade

- **Definition:** CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) is the language that controls the _____ and appearance of your HTML.
- **Pro Tool:** _____ (right-click and "Inspect") lets you view and test CSS live in the browser.
- **Style Inheritance:** Some styles (like font-family) on a parent tag (e.g., <body>) are _____ by all its child tags.

The CSS Hierarchy ("Who Wins the Style Fight?")

The "C" in CSS stands for _____, which means the order of your rules matters.

Method	Description	Priority Level
Inline Styles	Written directly on the HTML tag using the _____ attribute.	Highest (The Boss)
Embedded Styles	Styles placed in a <style> tag in the HTML <head>.	Medium
External Styles	Written in a separate _____ file and linked to the HTML.	Best Practice (Lowest, but most manageable)
Browser Default	The built-in style (e.g., blue links) applied by the browser (user agent).	Lowest

Deep Dive Discussion

1. **Best Practice:** Why is using an **External Stylesheet** the professional "Pro Way," even though Inline Styles have the highest priority?
2. **The Cascade:** If you have the same rule (color: red;) for an <h1> tag at the top of your external stylesheet and a conflicting rule (color: blue;) for the same <h1> tag at the bottom, which rule wins, and why?

II. Color and Selector Specificity

Painting with Code

CSS uses three main color formats:

Format	Stands For	Example	Description
Hex	_____	#FF69B4	A six-digit code representing R, G, and B values.
RGB	_____ _____	rgb(255, 105, 180)	Mixes red, green, and blue light (0-255).
HSL	_____ _____	hsl(330, 100%, 71%)	Based on the color wheel, saturation, and brightness.

- **Transparency:** To add transparency (alpha) to a color, you use the formats _____ and _____ with a value between 0.0 (transparent) and 1.0 (solid).

Selectors (Target Practice)

When two rules conflict, the browser uses _____ to pick a winner. The more specific selector wins.

Selector Type	Example	Symbol/Prefix	Specificity Rank
ID	_____	#	Highest (Heavyweight Champ)
Class	_____	.	Medium (Can be reused)
Element	p	(None)	Lowest (Styles all tags of that type)

Advanced Selectors

- **Descendant Selector (space):** Selects an element that is _____ an ancestor (e.g., article p).
- **Child Selector (>):** Selects an element _____ if it is a direct child (e.g., ul > li).

Application Activity

1. **Selector Showdown:** You want to style a single button on a specific page blue, but keep all other buttons red. Write the **Selector** that would win the "style fight" and make that one button blue:
 - **Selector Type:** _____
 - **Example Selector:** _____

III. Typography, Sizing, and The Box Model

Sizing Units

- **Absolute Unit:** A fixed size that never changes (e.g., the _____ unit).
- **Relative Unit (MVP):** _____ (**rem**) is relative to the font size of the _____ element, making it the best unit for scalable design.
- **Viewport Unit:** Units like _____ (**vw**) are based on the width or height of the user's browser window.

Typography

- **Font Stack:** A prioritized list of fonts (e.g., "Roboto", Arial, sans-serif) that ensures the browser always has a _____ option.
- **Generic Font Families:** _____ (fonts with "feet," like Times New Roman) vs. _____ (clean fonts, like Arial).
- **@font-face:** The special CSS rule that allows you to upload and use _____ font files.

The Box Model

The most important concept in CSS: every element is a box with four layers.

| Box Model Layer | Description | What it does |

| :--- | :--- | :--- |

| Content | Your actual text or image. | |

| Padding | The _____ cushioning between the content and the border. | Adds space inside the box. |

| Border | The line around the outside of the padding. | |

| Margin | The element's "personal space bubble." | Adds space outside the box, pushing other elements away. |

Deep Dive Discussion

1. **rem vs. px:** Why is it considered best practice to use rem for font sizing instead of px? (Hint: Think about accessibility and user preferences.)
2. **The Box Model Fight:** If you set a <header> to have padding: 20px and margin: 20px, describe where the two spaces would appear in relation to the element's border.

IV. Layout and CSS Magic Tricks

Layout (Arranging the Boxes)

Layout Property	What it Does	Best Use Case
position: fixed;	The element is _____ from the flow and "stuck" to the browser window.	Navigation bars or "Back to Top" buttons.
Flexbox (display: flex)	Arranges items perfectly in a single dimension (_____ or _____).	Centering a logo, aligning items horizontally.
Grid (display: grid)	Arranges items in two dimensions (_____ and _____).	Complex, whole-page structural layouts.

Pseudo-Classes & Pseudo-Elements

- **Pseudo-Classes (:)** - Style an element based on its _____ (e.g., _____ when the mouse is over it).
- **Pseudo-Elements (::)** - Style a specific _____ of an element (e.g., the first letter).
- **Content Generation:** You can insert text or images *before* or *after* an element using the content property with the pseudo-elements _____ and _____.

Application Activity

1. **Link Hover Style:** Write the CSS code that changes the text color of all links on the page to **green** when the user hovers over them.
 - **CSS Code:**

V. Progressive Enhancement & Validation

- **Progressive Enhancement:** A professional strategy where you build a simple, solid website that works for _____ browsers first, and **then** you layer on the fancy features for modern browsers.
- **CSS Validation:** The process of checking your CSS code against official standards using the _____ to find typos and syntax errors.